

JavaScript: Expression vs Statement

Expression

An expression is a piece of code that produces a value. It can be used wherever a value is expected (e.g., in assignments, function arguments).

Examples:

- $2 + 2 \rightarrow 4$
- `"hi".toUpperCase() → "HI"`
- `a > b → true or false`

Statement

A statement is an instruction that performs an action. It doesn't necessarily produce a value, but instead controls the flow of code.

Examples:

- `let x = 5;` → variable declaration statement
- `if (x > 3) { ... }` → if statement
- `for (let i=0; i<3; i++) { ... }` → loop statement
- `return x;` → return statement

Why `export styleObj;` is invalid:

- `styleObj` is just an expression (a value).
- The `export` keyword requires an **export statement**, not an arbitrary expression.

Correct forms:

- `export { styleObj };` → exports a named binding
- `export default styleObj;` → exports as the default export